



Figure 6: Test drive

If you want to add existing databases to your customised distro, create dumps of the structure and/or data of the desired databases and tables. Of course, compress large dump files using *bzip*, before uploading them.

The next step is to add MySQL users and permissions. You can create an admin account for yourself, and guest accounts if you want to.

Desktop options

The **Desktop** tab lets you set up *Automatic desktop user log in* (the root user is not allowed). If you have multiple users using your system, then it's safer to avoid this. You can also choose *Auto-start desktop programs*—which are run automatically after log-in.

Adding your own stuff

If you want to add some files to your distro, such as documents, presentations or pictures, use the *Overlay files* option under the *Files* tab to add them painlessly. Though you can add single files, try to use archives, which save space and makes it easier to manage these files. Archives will be extracted and the files copied to the desired directory after software packages are installed.

Finalising

You need to choose an appliance format for your distro from the available formats: Live CD/DVD (.iso), Xen guest, OVF virtual machine, Preload ISO (.iso), Amazon EC2 image,

VMware/VirtualBox (.vmdk), SUSE cloud, OpenStack, KVM, or USB stick/hard disk (default format). The Live CD/DVD option is often most suitable for installing to local systems.

Starting the build process

Once you are satisfied with your appliance's configuration, it's time to build it. Under the *Build* tab, click the *Build* button to begin. You can also add version numbers if you want to, especially if you plan to create modified versions in the future, where version numbers will be useful for comparison. Once that's done, download a brand new distro for your use.

Test drive your distro

Once your appliance is ready, you can take it for a test drive in a Web browser with JavaScript and Flash enabled. A test drive will open a new page (Figure 6) where you can view your distro in action, and check that all your features are working properly. On the top of the page, you will find a time limit for testing your distro. There's no networking (outgoing traffic) available during the test drive, but incoming traffic is acceptable.

SUSE Studio Gallery

The SUSE Studio Gallery showcases some popular builds by other people, which you can use if you want to—you can even test-drive them online without downloading them first. If you want to add your distro to the gallery, you can publish it so that others can use it. Under the *Share* tab, add the description of your distro, along with the tags for it, so that others can find it effectively. For example, if your distro is loaded with video editors, photo editors, photo management software, audio editors, 3D animation software and desktop publishing software, you have a new multimedia flavour which, if published, others may find useful. But the choice is yours—you can also keep your appliances private. **END** 

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